

Increasing Prayer at St Nicholas and home, during the Corona Virus pestilence. Opportunity to have Holy Communion, even if you cannot come to the Divine Liturgy

Thursday, March 6/18,2020, 3rd week of Great Lent

Dear Faithful in Christ: There is news about the coronavirus pestilence every day, and all governments are making additional restrictions almost every day. Things are happening in the world; we must be adjusting to them. If we make adjustments ONLY by following the orders of our secular governments, we are not Christians.

These days are a challenge for all of us, and especially for some of us who have extra time on our hands and do not know quite what to do with it. The most important response to this virus pandemic is to pray. Of course, we as a parish and hopefully as individuals also are being obedient to the requirements placed upon us by our governments. Archbishop Peter has made it clear in his pastoral letter we should obey the civil authorities. However, if we do not also, and preeminently, obey God, then we are not truly Christians. The response of Christians to any calamity or any need is prayer, and the more pressing the need, the more we increase our prayer.

Father Nicholas and I want to assure you that our “Diptychs”, that is the list of people we pray for in the Divine Liturgy, is very large and comprehensive and includes everyone who considers St. Nicholas his home. We both pray for everyone in the parish, every day, not just on days of that there is liturgy. You will be prayed for in the Divine Liturgy whether or not you attend. During the Divine Liturgy, we will place into the chalice all the particles of bread we have taken from the prosphora during the preparation service before the liturgy. Therefore, there is a particle of bread that was taken out when we prayed for you, and, that particle is placed in the chalice. We ask also that you pray for us, your unworthy pastors.

We should all be *increasing* our prayer, at home and yes, at church. Father Nicholas and I are prepared to serve the Presanctified liturgy every single week day, and the Divine Liturgy on Saturday and Sunday. That would allow 70 people to attend the services and commune. That is actually more communicants than we had on Sunday morning! I am asking everyone in the parish to rise to this challenge, to pray in the church and home, more than we usually do.

We are allowed to have only 10 people to assemble in the church for prayer at any one time, but we have devised a way to allow as many people who desire to commune on Sunday. If we get enough responses to this letter

(please respond by filling out the online form: <https://forms.gle/2JbPDstxa8MVoTzA7>),

Father Nicholas and I will wait in the church with the chalice, and people will come in small groups, probably by family, and partake of the Holy Mysteries, after the liturgy has ended. Those who desire and also have confession. We will stay as long as is necessary, but we won't wait longer than 15 minutes without anyone coming.

Here is our proposal to you. If you prepare properly for the Holy Mysteries, then you may come after the church services to partake of the Holy Mysteries. Here is what you should do. Come to the church, and stay in your car or stand near it. Don't congregate in the parking lot, or else we might be breaking the city's rules. If everyone

stays in his car or very near to it and not near someone else, then we are not breaking the rules of assembly. Every once in a while, a few of you will come in. We will begin this process at approximately 11:45 am.

When our routine is changed, especially when we have more time, and when there are things that distract us, our prayer suffers. Therefore, as your pastors, we are trying to help you not to have your prayer suffer by making requirements if you wish to commune the Holy Mysteries, whether or not you are attending the Divine Liturgy. Everyone who wishes to commune the holy mysteries should definitely say the Preparation Prayers for Holy Communion. These consist primarily of 3 Psalms, the Canon of Preparation, and 10 prayers. If you do not say these prayers, you should not commune. A person should also have had confession within the past month, at a minimum. Those who do not attend the liturgy must also say the Typica prayers.

The “Typica” prayers are the normal prayers that said in church or at home if we do not have Divine Liturgy. They are a shortened version of Divine Liturgy, without, of course any of the parts that relate specifically to the consecration. You may find a complete version of them for this coming Sunday (the Sunday of the cross) here:

<http://www.orthodox.net/services/typica-sunday-of-the-cross-2020-03-22-ns.doc>.

Please download this document and print it, or even read it from laptop or notepad, and those who have excellent eyesight may be able to use their phone.

This document will be provided for each Sunday. In the reference links at the end of this letter is the URL from which the Typica service above was created (for those who want to learn liturgics, or just want to put the service together themselves).

Please contact Fr Nicholas or Fr Seraphim if you will be coming for the Holy Mysteries after the Divine Liturgy on Sunday.

Priest Seraphim & Priest Nicholas

Links and Information

Google Form: <https://forms.gle/2JbPDstxa8MVoTzA7> (Fill this out in order to be considered for attendance of any of our MANY services)

- Priest Seraphim Holland seraphim@orthodox.net 972 658-5433
- Priest Nicholas Park frnicholas@orthodox.net 972 839-2439
- Church Web Page: <http://www.orthodox.net>
- Church Facebook Page: <https://www.facebook.com/orthodoxnet/>
- EMAIL List: <http://groups.google.com/group/saint-nicholas-orthodox-church>

Typica:

<http://www.orthodox.net/services/typica-sunday-of-the-cross-2020-03-22-ns.doc> (Complete file for the 3rd Sunday of Great Lent)

<https://fatherjohn.blogspot.com/2020/03/doing-typika-at-home.html>

Other recommended Prayers

[A Moleben sung in time of devastating epidemic and death-bearing pestilence. Abbreviated, for use when no priest is present.](#)

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/moleben-pestilence-reader.pdf>

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/moleben-pestilence-reader.doc>

Prayers to St Nikephoros:

<http://www.orthodox.net/articles/prayer-to-nikephoros-the-leper-during-the-coronavirus-pandemic.pdf>

<http://www.orthodox.net/articles/prayer-to-nikephoros-the-leper-during-the-coronavirus-pandemic.doc>

Akathist to our Sweetest Lord Jesus Christ

<http://stjohnah.org/akathist-to-our-sweetest-lord-jesus-christ>

Akathist to the Most Holy Theotokos

http://www.fatheralexander.org/booklets/english/m_akathist_e.htm

Supplicatory Canon to the Most Holy Theotokos

http://web.archive.org/web/20001204003900/http://pages.prodigy.net/frjohnwhiteford/mpthn_canon.htm

This Letter:

http://www.orthodox.net/articles/pastoral-letter-corona-virus-05_2020-03-19.html

http://www.orthodox.net/articles/pastoral-letter-corona-virus-05_2020-03-19.pdf

http://www.orthodox.net/articles/pastoral-letter-corona-virus-05_2020-03-19.doc

Previous Pastoral Letters:

http://www.orthodox.net/articles/pastoral-letter-corona-virus-04_2020-03-17.pdf

http://www.orthodox.net/articles/pastoral-letter-corona-virus-04_2020-03-17.doc

http://www.orthodox.net/articles/pastoral-letter-corona-virus-03_2020-03-17.pdf

http://www.orthodox.net/articles/pastoral-letter-corona-virus-03_2020-03-17.doc

http://www.orthodox.net/articles/pastoral-letter-corona-virus-02_2020-03-14.pdf

http://www.orthodox.net/articles/pastoral-letter-corona-virus-02_2020-03-14.doc

[Coronavirus Instructional Letter by Archbishop Peter \(March 4/17,2020\)](#)

https://chicagodiocese.org/news_200317_1

[Second Revised Mayoral Declaration of Local State of Disaster Due to Public Health Emergency](#)

<https://www.mckinneytexas.org/DocumentCenter/View/22842/Mayor-Declaration-Update-3-17-20-signed>